

LANDSCAPE CHANGER

The loss of wolves from Yellowstone in the 1920s meant that within a few years its forests were being damaged by the increasing numbers of wapiti. In particular, quaking aspens failed to regenerate. Today, wolves are helping to control wapiti once more.

> The world's first national park, established in 1872

WAPITI

**FIERY BEGINNINGS**

Lodgepole pines are adapted to cope with occasional wildfires. The trees burn rapidly, but their tightly closed cones require the heat of a wildfire to melt the resinous glue that seals them, releasing the seeds to germinate in the newly cleared area.

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Yellowstone's supervolcano is the only one on land in the world

LODGEPOLE PINE

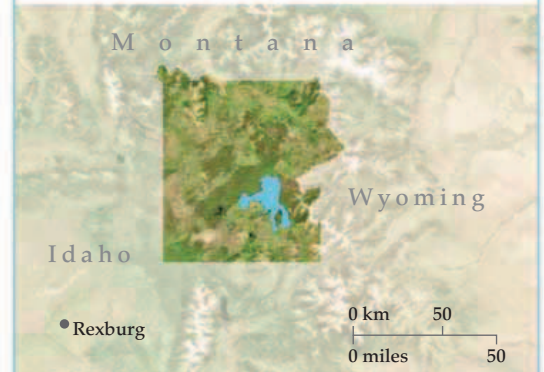
**TOO MUCH COMPETITION**

Named for the dramatic slash of scarlet on the lower jaw, cutthroat trout are threatened by habitat loss, disease, and competition from other fish species introduced for sport fishing. Those in Yellowstone are a separate subspecies. They are a key component of the diets of bald eagles and osprey, so the decline of this fish would also lead to a decline in these birds of prey.

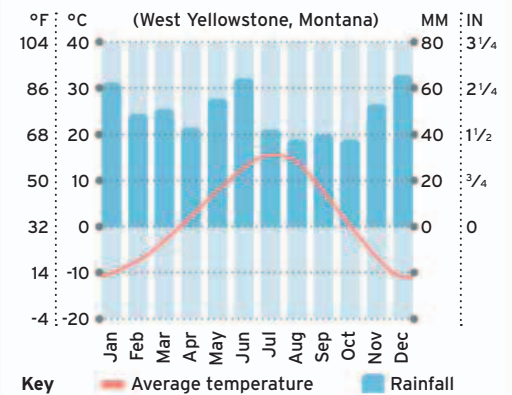
YELLOWSTONE CUT-THROAT TROUT

**LOCATION**

The national park lies primarily within the western US state of Wyoming. It is part of the South Central Rockies ecoregion.

**CLIMATE**

Yellowstone experiences a cool, temperate climate, with cool summers and long, cold winters. Precipitation is evenly spread throughout the year, falling as heavy snow between November and March.

**SUPERVOLCANO**

Around 640,000 years ago, a massive volcano erupted, which caused it to collapse and form the giant Yellowstone Caldera. The supervolcano beneath the caldera is still active, and the caldera is closely monitored for signs of increasing activity. Between 1,000 and 2,000 earthquakes and tremors are recorded in the area every year.

